

Congress: Benaras, Calcutta, and Surat Session

***Gopal Krishna Gokhale** chaired the 1905 A.D. Varanasi session of Congress. He founded the '**Servants of India Society**' the same year. In 1906, the Congress party was divided on the issue of the presidentship of the Calcutta session but the division was avoided when an agreement was reached on the name of Dadabhai Naoroji. Resolutions on Self-rule, **Swadeshi**, **Boycott** and **National education** were passed in the Calcutta session in 1906 A.D.

*Dadabhai Naoroji also remembered as '**Grand Old Man of India**' was the first Indian who got elected to British Parliament in 1892 from central Finsbury constituency on a ticket of Liberal Party. He was the president of Congress in **1886, 1893** and **1906** sessions. He was the first Indian to be appointed as professor of Maths and Natural Philosophy at Elphinstone College, Mumbai. In 1851 A.D., he started Gujarati Magazine named as '**Rast Goftar**'. *C.Y. Chintamani said that many intelligent and selfless leaders had embellished for the people of India, but in his era, no one was as the Dadabhai Naoroji. *Gokhale said, "**If there is God somewhere, he is Dadabhai Naoroji**". *A split took place in Congress at Surat in **1907** when the dispute again arose for the Presidentship of 23rd Session of Congress. Moderates wanted Rash Behari Ghosh as President while **Lala Lajpat Rai** was the choice of Extremists. At last **Rash Behari Ghosh** became the President and Congress was divided between Moderates and Extremists.

1. "A graduate at 18, professor and associate editor of the Sudharak at 20, Secretary of the Sarvajanik Sabha and of the Provincial Conference at 25, Secretary of the National Congress at 29, leading witness before an important Royal Commission at 31, Provincial legislator at 34, Imperial legislator at 36, President of the Indian National Congress at 39. a patriot whom Mahatma Gandhi himself regarded as his master".

This is how a biographer describes:

- (a) Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya
- (b) Mahadev Govind Ranade
- (c) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- (d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Gopal Krishna Gokhale was born on May 9, 1866 A.D., in Ratnagiri (Maharashtra). He graduated from Elphinstone College in 1884 A.D. and was appointed a professor of Political economy and History at Ferguson College in Poona. Gokhale became as a protege of social reformer Mahadev Govind Ranade. He was a member of the Deccan Education Society. Gokhale fought for decades to obtain greater political representation and power over public affairs for common Indians. He first joined Congress in 1889 A.D. at the Bombay session. Gokhale became a member of the Bombay Legislative Council and then the Imperial Legislative Council. Gandhiji often referred to Gokhale as 'Mahatma.' He was the political mentor of Gandhiji.

2. **Gopal Krishna Gokhale presided over the session of Congress in –**

- (a) 1902
- (b) 1905
- (c) 1906
- (d) 1909

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

Benaras Session of INC in 1905 A.D. was presided over by Gopal Krishna Gokhale. He founded Servants of India Society in 1905 A.D.

3. **Who presided over the Benaras Session of the Indian National Congress in 1905:**

- (a) Surendranath Bannerji
- (b) Feroz Shah Mehta
- (c) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- (d) Dinshaw Wacha

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

4. **Which of the following leaders presided over the Congress Session at Calcutta in 1906?**

- (a) B.G. Tilak
- (b) G.K. Gokhale
- (c) Aurobindo Ghosh
- (d) Dadabhai Naoroji

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

In 1906 A.D., Congress was in real danger of splitting into two groups. The extremists were more popular than the moderates. Before this session, the extremists would have taken over Congress had they elected a leader among them. But it was not done. The moderates were politically intelligent. In 1906 A.D., the session at Calcutta was presided over by Dadabhai Naoroji. The moderates had chosen Naoroji to preside Congress. Naoroji, 'the Grand old man of India,' was respected by both moderates and extremists alike. In this session, the Congress adopted Swaraj as the goal of Indian people. Moderates toned down the resolution in a compromised state and made it self-Government meant obtaining the self-governing British colonies."

5. At the Calcutta Session of the Indian National Congress (INC) held in 1906, the Flag of Swaraj for India was unfurled by

- (a) G.K. Gokhale
- (b) A.O. Hume
- (c) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

At the Calcutta session of the Indian National Congress (INC) held in 1906 A.D., the flag of Swaraj for India was unfurled by president of session Dadabhai Naoroji.

6. Congress passed the 'Swaraj' resolution in the year 1905. The purpose of the resolution was-

- (a) right to make a constitution for themselves but it was not done
- (b) to secure self-rule
- (c) responsible Government
- (d) self-Government

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (*)

The Indian National Congress took up the Swaraj call in its Benaras Session, 1905 AD and later in 1906 AD Calcutta session it was fully passed. The main purpose of the resolution was "to serve self-rule" and boycotting British products and the revival of domestic products and production process of Indian industrialization and better education policy for India.

7. Swaraj as a national demand was first made by:

- (a) B.G. Tilak
- (b) C.R. Das
- (c) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (d) Mahatma Gandhi

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Swaraj (self-rule) was first articulated in the Presidential address of Dadabhai Naoroji as the goal of Congress in its Calcutta session in 1906 A.D..

8. In which of the following sessions of Indian National Congress, the word 'Swaraj' was uttered for the first time?

- (a) Benaras Session, 1905
- (b) Calcutta Session, 1906
- (c) Surat Session, 1907
- (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

At the Calcutta Congress session, 'Swaraj' was uttered as the goal of the Indian people in December, 1906 A.D. In his presidential address, Naoroji declared that the goal of the Indian National Congress 'Self-Government or Swaraj', was same as of United Kingdom'.

9. The first leader to use the word 'Swaraj' was :

- (a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
- (b) Lala Lajpat Rai
- (c) S.C. Bose
- (d) Mahatma Gandhi

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (a)

Bal Gangadhar Tilak's (1856-1920 A.D.) popular statement was 'Swaraj is my birthright, I shall have it'. Although the word 'Swaraj' was first used by 'Dayanand Saraswati.' Option (a) might be the closest answer.

10. Dadabhai Naoroji was formally known as :

- (a) Punjab Kesari
- (b) Gujarat Ratna
- (c) Guru Dev
- (d) Grand Old Man of India

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

Dadabhai Naoroji known as the Grand Old Man of India, was Parsi intellectual educationist and an early Indian political and social leader. He was first Indian elected to the House of Commons in 1892 as a Liberal Party Member from Central Finsbury constituency in the United Kingdom. He was elected as the President of INC in 1886, 1893, and 1906. C.Y. Chintamani, Indian editor Journalist, liberal politician, told about Dadabhai Naoroji that "Many intelligent and selfless leader had embellished for the people of India, but in his era, no one was like Dadabhai Naoroji." On the other hand, Gokhale said that "if there is a God somewhere, he is Dadabhai Naoroji.

11. Who was called the 'Grand Old Man of India'?

- (a) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (b) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- (c) Ramesh Chandra Banerjee
- (d) Sir Syed Ahmad Khan

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

12. Who among the following is known by the title of "The Grand Old Man"?

- (a) Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
- (b) W. C. Banerjee
- (c) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (d) Motilal Nehru

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

13. Which one of the following statements is not correct about Dadabhai Naoroji?

- (a) He wrote a book 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India.'
- (b) He worked as a Professor of Gujarati at University College, London
- (c) He laid the foundation of woman's education in Bombay
- (d) He was elected as a member of British Parliament on the ticket of the Conservative Party

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Dadabhai Naoroji was elected as a member of British Parliament on the ticket of Liberal Party. Thus, statement (d) is not correct.

14. Which one of the following statements is not correct about Dadabhai Naoroji?

- (a) He was the first Indian to be appointed as Professor of Mathematics and Physics at Elphinstone College, Bombay.
- (b) He was elected as the member of British Parliament in 1892.
- (c) He started a Gujarati Journal, 'Rast Goftar.'
- (d) For four times he had presided over the Indian National Congress.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

Dadabhai Naoroji presided over INC sessions for three times in 1886 AD, 1893 AD and in 1906 AD.

15. Who was first Indian to be elected to the British Parliament?

- (a) Ras Bihari Bose
- (b) Surendranath Banerjee
- (c) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (d) Vithalbhai Patel

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

Dadabhai Naoroji, the Grand Old Man of India, was the first Indian to become a Member of British Parliament in United Kingdom's House of Commons.

16. At which session was the Indian National Congress (INC) divided into two groups – 'Naram Dal' and 'Garam Dal'?

- (a) Bombay
- (b) Surat
- (c) Allahabad
- (d) Lahore

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

The Indian National Congress was formed in 1885 and was divided into two factions in 1907 A.D., namely extremists – Garam Dal led by Lala Lajpat Rai and moderates 'Naram Dal' led by Ras Bihari Ghosh. Ras Bihari Ghosh succeeded to become its President. Reason of this division was four Resolutions Swadeshi, Boycott, National Education and self-Rule which passed in 1906 in Calcutta session. Extremists wanted to continue this resolution while the liberals were not in favour.

17. In which session was the Congress divided into Moderates and Extremists?

- (a) Bombay
- (b) Surat
- (c) Calcutta
- (d) Nagpur

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

18. Where did the Indian Congress got divided into two wings moderates and extremists ?

- (a) Surat Session, 1907
- (b) Lahore Session, 1909
- (c) Calcutta Session, 1911
- (d) Karachi Session, 1913

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

19. The President of the Surat Session of Indian National Congress (1907) was :

- (a) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
- (c) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- (d) R.B. Ghosh

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

20. Four resolutions were passed at the famous Calcutta Session of Indian National Congress in 1906. The question of either retention or rejection of these four resolutions became the cause of a split in Congress at the next Congress Session held in Surat in 1907. Which one of the following was not one of those resolutions?

- (a) Annulment of the partition of Bengal
- (b) Boycott
- (c) National Education
- (d) Swadeshi

I.A.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.